



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

Request for Proposals

For

WEBSITE DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT

For

HALTON POLICE BOARD

Request for Proposals No.: **RFP-01-26**

Issued: **02 SEPTEMBER 2026**

Question deadline: **18 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 5:00 pm EST**

Submission Deadline: **01 OCTOBER 2026 at 5:00 pm EST**

Proposals must be submitted electronically to: info@haltonpoliceboard.ca

ELECTRONIC SUBMISSIONS ONLY

PART 1 – INVITATION AND SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

1.1 Invitation to Proponents

This Request for Proposals (the “RFP”) is an invitation by Halton Police Board (“HPB”) to prospective proponents to submit proposals for the design, development, and launch of a new website.

The Halton Police Board wants to create a modern, accessible, and highly functional digital presence. This project aims to deliver a website that prioritizes user-friendly navigation, mobile responsiveness, strict accessibility standards, and seamless integration with our existing systems. We need a secure and engaging platform that serves our community and stakeholders effectively.

1.2 RFP Contact

Questions in relation to this RFP are to be addressed to:

Jessica Warren – info@haltonpoliceboard.ca

1.3 RFP Timetable

- Issue Date of RFP: **02 SEPTEMBER 2026**
- Question deadline: **18 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 5:00 PM EST**
- Submission Deadline: **01 OCTOBER 2026, 5:00 PM EST**
- Anticipated Contract Award: **NOVEMBER 2026**

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



The RFP timetable is tentative only and may be changed by HPB at any time.

1.4 Submission of Proposals

Proposals must be submitted electronically to info@haltonpoliceboard.ca via an encrypted email and passwords must be exchanged via a separate communication.

Documents should not be embedded within uploaded files, as the embedded files may not be accessible or evaluated. Submissions by other methods will not be accepted. Submissions received after the due date will not be accepted and will be automatically disqualified.

1.5 Intellectual Property

All code, designs, reports, and other documents to be produced by the successful Proponent to this Request for Proposals shall, on submission to HPB, become the property of HPB.

2.0 Project Deliverables

2.1 Website Design and User Experience

- Design a modern, clean, and professional website that reflects the Halton Police Board's brand, with clearly defined terms and built-in protocols requiring periodic reviews of the site throughout the term of the contract. Provide an intuitive, mobile-responsive layout across all device types.
- Migrate all historical records, by-laws, and policies. Implement automated 301 redirects for legacy URLs to eliminate broken links.
- Provision separate Development, Staging, and Production environments. Include mandatory SSL, automated daily backups (30-day retention), and role-based user permissions. Ensure intuitive, user-friendly navigation so visitors can easily find information.
- Deploy an advanced search engine capable of full-text indexing across all site pages and uploaded media (including PDF, DOCX, and XLSX).
- Provide a structured, multi-year SLA requiring mandatory quarterly security patching, accessibility health checks, and contractual performance reviews.

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

- Guarantee strict adherence to **WCAG 2.1 Level AA** standards and AODA (Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act) regulations. All data must reside on Canadian servers in compliance with **MFIPPA**.

2.2 Development and Integration

- The CMS implementation must meet OWASP ASVS Level 2 requirements and explicitly address mitigation of OWASP Top 10 risks. Bidding vendors must submit their planned security testing framework in their proposal and deliver a formal ASVS validation report signed by a qualified security professional prior to system sign-off.
- Build the website on a secure and easy-to-use Content Management System (CMS) featuring a modular block editor that allows non-technical HPB staff to update content effortlessly. The CMS must enforce mandatory Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for all administrative accounts and maintain a permanent, immutable audit log of all user logins and content changes.
- Integrate the new website with HPB's existing internal systems, databases, and third-party tools as required. This includes establishing secure API endpoints or webhooks for external video streaming archives, public email newsletter subscription databases, and community contact forms.
- Ensure robust security measures are in place to protect the website from vulnerabilities and data breaches. This must include automated daily off-site backups with a minimum 30-day retention policy, continuous uptime and DDoS monitoring, an automated security patching pipeline, and strict compliance with MFIPPA data residency requirements (guaranteeing all data, backups, and hosting infrastructure reside within Canadian borders).

2.3 Testing, Launch, and Follow-Up Support

Conduct comprehensive testing for bugs, broken links, usability, performance, and security before the official launch.

Provide training sessions and instructional materials for HPB staff on how to manage and update the website.

The Proponent must provide clearly defined post-launch support and ongoing maintenance services to ensure the website remains secure, functional, current, and fully operational after go-live. Proposals must describe the scope, duration, service levels, and delivery model for ongoing support and maintenance.

At a minimum, ongoing support and maintenance must include:

- Troubleshooting and resolution of technical issues, defects, and broken functionality

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

- Regular CMS, plugin, module, theme, and dependency updates
- Security patching and remediation of identified vulnerabilities
- Monitoring of website uptime, performance, and critical errors
- Bug fixes and issue resolution within defined service timelines
- Ongoing compatibility support for modern browsers and mobile devices
- Content publishing support and minor administrative assistance, if available
- Access to technical support resources through defined support channels and escalation procedures

The Proponent must identify:

- The length of the included post-launch support period
- Whether support is provided during business hours only or includes after-hours / emergency response
- Expected response times and resolution targets by issue severity
- Any maintenance exclusions, assumptions, or optional support packages
- The process for submitting, tracking, escalating, and resolving support requests

HPB prefers a Proponent that can provide reliable long-term support and maintenance beyond launch, including ongoing technical stewardship, regular updates, and advisory support as website needs evolve.

2.4 Hosting, Security, and Data Protection Requirements

- The Proponent must provide verifiable security assurance evidence, including a current SOC 2 Type II report (covering the trailing 12-month period) or ISO/IEC 27001 certification for both the Proponent's organization and the chosen hosting environment. If a SOC 3 or a bridge letter is used, it must be accompanied by the full executive summary of the underlying audit.
- The successful Proponent shall provide a secure, enterprise grade hosting environment that guarantees 99.9% uptime and aligns with recognized information security best practices, including the intent and control objectives of ISO/IEC 27001 and SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria (Security, Availability, and Confidentiality). Crucially, to comply with Ontario's Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

(MFIPPA), all primary, secondary, backup, and disaster-recovery hosting infrastructure must reside strictly within Canadian borders. The Proponent must also specify their automated daily backup protocols, disaster recovery timelines (RTO/RPO), and provide a mandatory 24-hour breach notification guarantee.

2.4.1 Data Residency and Sovereignty

- The Proponent must explicitly comply with the Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (MFIPPA), including breach notification support and privacy safeguarding obligations. All production, backup, and disaster-recovery data must be hosted and stored exclusively within Canada. Data must always remain under Canadian jurisdiction **and must not navigate through foreign servers or proxy loops**. Hosting must comply with applicable federal and provincial privacy and data-protection legislation. The Proponent must identify **and secure written approval from HPB for** all hosting provider(s) **and** any subcontractors involved in hosting or data processing, **with a commitment that no downstream provider changes will occur without 30 days prior written notice to HPB.**

2.4.2 Identity and Access Management

- Access controls must include quarterly access recertification reviews, enforcement of least privilege, and documented break-glass access procedures.
- Administrative access to the CMS, hosting environment, and management interfaces must require Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcing hardware keys or authenticator apps (SMS-based MFA is prohibited).
- Role-based access controls must be implemented to enforce the principle of least privilege.
- Strong authentication controls must be in place, including:
 - Enforcement of NIST-compliant password policies;
 - Access review and removal procedures; and
 - Brute-force locking mechanisms to protect against unauthorized or excessive access.

2.4.3 Change Management and Audit Logging

- Audit logs must be centralized, time-synchronized, protected from tampering, and exportable to HPB upon request.

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

- All changes to the website must be logged, including:
 - Content updates
 - Configuration changes
 - User access changes
 - System updates or patches
- Audit logs must:
 - Record user identity, origin IP address, timestamp, and change details;
 - Be protected from alteration or deletion via write-once-read-many (WORM) or immutable cryptographic logging architectures; and
 - Be retained for a minimum of twelve (12) months.
- Logs must be available to HPB automatically via standard export formats (CSV/JSON) upon request for audit, compliance, or investigative purposes.

2.4.4 Backup, Recovery, and Availability

- Automated backups must be performed regularly and securely.
- At minimum:
 - Daily incremental backups **with a 30-day retention loop**, and weekly full backups **retained for 12 months**;
 - Backups must be encrypted at rest using AES-256, be stored in Canada, and be physically and logically isolated (air-gapped) or immutable where technically feasible. Bidders must declare their guaranteed Recovery Time Objective (RTO) (maximum target: 4 hours) and Recovery Point Objective (RPO) (maximum target: 24 hours), and submit the results of their quarterly restore testing to HPB.
- The Proponent must describe recovery time objectives (RTO) and recovery point objectives (RPO).

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8



2.4.5 Security Monitoring and Incident Management

- Incident response must define severity-based notification SLAs aligned with NIST SP 800-61, including a mandatory 2-hour notification window for Critical/High incidents, followed by full root-cause analysis (RCA) reporting within 5 business days of resolution.
- Managed Layer 3/4 and Layer 7 DDoS protection must be implemented, integrated with CDN/WAF services, and supported by documented response runbooks and capable of mitigating automated top-tier web scraping attacks.
- The hosting environment must provide continuous monitoring for cybersecurity threats, including:
 - Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) attacks
 - Intrusion and brute-force attempts
 - Malware and anomalous activity
- DDoS mitigation protections must be implemented to maintain service availability.
- The Proponent must maintain defined incident response procedures, including:
 - Detection and alerting
 - Incident containment and remediation
 - Timely notification of HPB in the event of a material security incident

2.4.6 Encryption and Secure Communications

- All data in transit must be encrypted using industry-standard protocols (e.g., TLS). TLS 1.2 or higher (preferably TLS 1.3) must be enforced along with HTTP Strict Transport Security (HSTS), Content Security Policy (CSP), and standard OWASP-recommended security headers.
- Sensitive data must be encrypted at rest using strong encryption methods.
- All SSL/TLS certificates must be actively managed and renewed by the proponent prior to expiry.



2.4.7 Vulnerability and Patch Management

- The CMS, hosting platform, and all third-party components must be kept current with security patches enforcing a deployment window of less than 72 hours for critical/zero-day patches.
- The Proponent must demonstrate a proactive vulnerability management approach, including:
 - Regular updates
 - Remediation of known vulnerabilities
 - Secure configuration practices
- The Proponent shall provide HPB with a comprehensive vulnerability assessment and a full application penetration test report prior to production go-live. The assessment must be conducted within thirty (30) days of the proposed go-live date and include all externally accessible web applications, APIs, supporting infrastructure, and associated services.

The report shall:

- Identify all discovered vulnerabilities, including their severity ratings (Critical, High, Medium, and Low).
 - Confirm that all Critical and High vulnerabilities have been remediated prior to go-live.
 - Document any remaining Medium or Low vulnerabilities, including risk ratings, compensating controls, and remediation timelines.
 - Include the date of the assessment, assessment methodology, and tools utilized.
 - Provide evidence of remediation and re-testing for identified vulnerabilities.
 - Be performed by an independent qualified security assessor or through an industry-recognized vulnerability scanning platform.
 - Be provided to HPB for review and acceptance prior to final production deployment.
- HPB reserves the right to request additional remediation, independent validation, or penetration testing where identified risks are deemed unacceptable.



2.4.8 Governance, Documentation, and Assurance

- The Proponent must support a secure exit and transition plan. Upon termination or contract end, the proponent must deliver a complete, unencrypted repository of all site assets, codebases, and database schemas in standard formats (e.g., SQL and clean asset directories). Following confirmed hand-off, the proponent must execute a secure deletion of all HPB data from all development, staging, production, and backup environments, and provide a formal, signed Certificate of Secure Destruction within 14 business days.

2.5 Exit and Transition Assistance

The Proponent must support a secure exit and transition plan, including data export, credential rotation, and secure deletion attestation.

3.0 Proposal Evaluation

Proposals will be evaluated using the following rating system:

Proposal Evaluation Criteria	Weighting (Points)
Corporate Profile and Relevant Experience	30 points
Understanding of the Assignment	20 points
Methodology	20 points
Proposed Platform & Coding Language (with emphasis on native, non-proprietary CMS systems, block-editor user interfaces, and modular drag-and-drop mechanics that allow total autonomous editing/adding/deleting of content, agendas, and policy structures by Board staff without ongoing developer reliance)	10 points
Cost	20 points
Total Points	100 points



**HALTON
POLICE
BOARD**
EXCELLENCE IN GOVERNANCE

3.1 Corporate Profile and Relevant Experience

- Provide a narrative on why and how the proponent is best suited to provide the prime consultant services for this web development project.
- Provide a description of experience in projects of similar type, scope, and complexity in the past five (5) years within Canada, specifically highlighting work with public sector or board organizations.

3.2 Understanding of the Assignment

- Demonstrate understanding of the project, the required web deliverables, and the target audience.
- Demonstrate an understanding of HPB's specific needs regarding accessibility, mobile responsiveness, and system integration.

3.3 Methodology

- Propose a clear methodology and project timeline to successfully complete the design, development, and launch phases of the assignment.

3.4 Cost Proposal

Cost proposals must include proposed fees for all phases of development, software licensing (if applicable), training, and a fixed annual cost structure for Year 1 through Year 5 covering web hosting, security certificate management, and software support/patching.

Cost Proposals will be scored in accordance with the following formula:

(lowest price / proponent's price) × weighting = proponent's pricing points

Excellence in Governance

2485 North Service Road West, Oakville, Ontario, L6M 3H8